ACTIVITY 088

Emotional Volume Myth

Expression & Interpretation

6 minutes / One expressive lyric line.

Communicate a strong feeling without assuming louder is better.

DICTION

Clear a word

TIMING

Allow a pause

PHRASE DIRECTION

Lead to a word

Three expressive tools at a moderate volume. Choose one that communicates the feeling.

1. Choose a feeling such as wonder or reassurance and speak the words in a natural voice.
2. Sing at a moderate volume, changing diction, timing, or phrase direction to communicate it.
3. Ask listeners which detail carried the feeling; compare two gentle interpretations.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Listeners identify expressive details beyond volume.

COMMON TRAP

Assuming a strong feeling needs a loud voice.

MAKE IT WORK

Use an ensemble discussion rather than individual demonstrations.